

FILM REVIEW

GHAJINI

Bone Cruncher

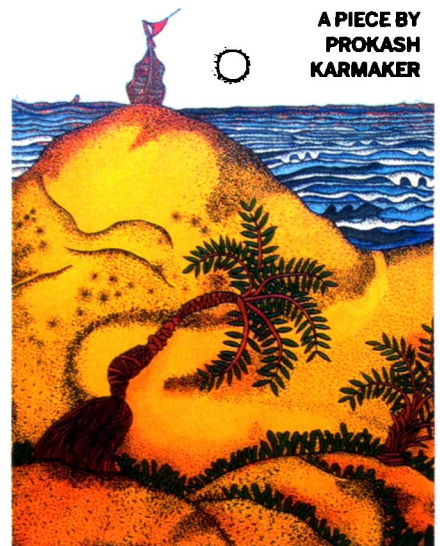
Director: A.R. Murugadoss
Starring: Aamir Khan, Asin, Jiah Khan

Imagine Hong Kong action dipped in south Indian masala. The sound of bones being crushed, the crick of necks being twisted, the thwack of steel rods connecting with bare heads. Now put all this in one movie, with an Aamir Khan screaming like an animal when the memory—that elemental thing that comes and goes like a mystery guest in *Ghajini*—returns to haunt him. This is not an easy movie, as those who've seen Christopher Nolan's *Memento* and A.R. Murugadoss's Tamil version, know. Yet it is heart-stopping in its intensity. Catch Aamir looking into Asin's eyes and telling her he loves her. See him trying to reach out to her

as she lies dying. Watch him again as he stares in confusion at the face of the man he has vowed to kill, not remembering who he is. It is brutal, but it is also searingly effective as it grabs you by the neck. And yes, it is ultimately a romance, of a tycoon who falls in love with a struggling model. He loses her and his memory, which returns to him every 15 minutes. It's what Hollywood would call a high concept movie, but Murugadoss sustains it over three hours, powering it with performances which seem to feel the pain in every pore. Hand-to-hand combat, head butts, blood that looks chillingly real. And leaves a hole the size of a fist in your heart. Watch it, but without the children.

by Kaveree Bamzai

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

A PIECE BY
PROKASH
KARMAKER

ART EXHIBITION

Colour
CODED

In a show that will kick-start the year on an upbeat note, Colours 2009 is an art extravaganza that celebrates its fourth year in January 2009. The best from various schools of art from across India come together for an event that features over 100 paintings and more than 60 senior and young contemporary artists. Their works display the diversity of forms, colour schemes and subjects. From water colours on glass, to canvas filled with colour and paintings on wood, the art represents the cultural ethos and traditions of different parts of India. "Nearly 15 new artists will get a platform to exhibit their creativity in the same space where veteran artists like Lalita Lajmi, Gurcharan Singh and Samir Mondal will show," says curator Sunil Chauhan. While each artist puts his best work forward, the show-stoppers, Chauhan says, will be the works of Delhi-based Vijendra Sharma and Kolkata-based Sanatan Dinda. From January 2 to 8, 2009, at the M.C. Ghia Hall, Kala Ghoda, Mumbai.

by Swati Mathur

